

Chapter 4 — Constitutional Amendment and Stewardship Review

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1. Purpose

Govern rare constitutional change while preserving identity, continuity, and the Owner Authorization Ceremony.

2. Scope

This chapter governs all amendments, all publications, authorized amendments, constitutional amendments, constitutional proposals, constitutional stewardship, invariant changes. It defines institutional procedure and does not create constitutional, technical, operational, or security authority.

3. Authority and source requirements

Book I Constitutional Governance and Decision 58; Book II Constitutional Kernel; Book VIII verification ladder. Book I prevails. Final Books V and VI retain their operational and security/privacy/trust execution authorities; Book VII supplies institutional governance only.

4. Definitions and roles

Primary accountable roles: Constitutional Steward, Proposal Sponsor, Amendment Program Lead, Constitutional Archivist. Authority means explicit bounded permission to decide; expertise and administrative access do not create it.

5. Normative controls

CST-04-001 — Use Constitutional Change Objects

Every proposed amendment **MUST** record motivation, insufficiency of current principles, alternatives, benefits, risks, compatibility, affected decisions, verification, migration, rollback, Owner Authorization Ceremony status, and disposition.

- Applicability: constitutional proposals
- Responsible role: Constitutional Steward
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Constitutional Change Object
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CST-04-002 — Apply the twenty-year test

A proposal **MUST** explain whether the change should remain true in twenty years and why ordinary policy, architecture, or engineering change is insufficient.

- Applicability: constitutional proposals
- Responsible role: Proposal Sponsor
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Stewardship Analysis
- Severity: Critical

- Exception authority: none

CST-04-003 — Protect the Owner Authorization Ceremony

Only the Owner, or Authority explicitly delegated through the constitutional process where Book I permits delegation, MAY approve constitutional change through the Owner Authorization Ceremony.

- Applicability: constitutional amendments
- Responsible role: Constitutional Steward
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Owner Authorization Ceremony Record
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: Owner

CST-04-004 — Recognize invariant changes

A proposal affecting a constitutional invariant MUST explicitly state that it may create a fundamentally different constitutional system and MUST use extraordinary recognition.

- Applicability: invariant changes
- Responsible role: Constitutional Steward
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Invariant Impact Finding
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: Owner

CST-04-005 — Verify before incorporation

Amendments MUST progress through analysis, simulation, compatibility review, Owner Authorization Ceremony, staged adoption, observation, and incorporation.

- Applicability: authorized amendments
- Responsible role: Amendment Program Lead
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Verification Ladder Evidence
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CST-04-006 — Preserve immutable history

The signed Constitution, amendment proposal, Owner Authorization Ceremony Record, prior versions, commentary, Evidence Objects, and disposition MUST remain immutable and publicly distinguishable by status.

- Applicability: all amendments
- Responsible role: Constitutional Archivist
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Version and Custody Manifest

- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CST-04-007 — Separate authority from commentary

Commentary, principles, rules, and operational policies **MUST NOT** be presented as constitutional text or silently gain constitutional force.

- Applicability: all publications
- Responsible role: Constitutional Archivist
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Publication Classification Review
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CST-04-008 — Conduct stewardship review

Periodic stewardship review **MUST** assess continuity, legitimacy, outdated assumptions, unresolved harms, amendment pressure, and whether lower-order artifacts have drifted from Book I.

- Applicability: constitutional stewardship
- Responsible role: Constitutional Steward
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Stewardship Review Report
- Severity: High
- Exception authority: Owner

6. Required procedure

The proposer **MUST** submit the classified proposal and evidence. The recorder **MUST** verify authority and conflicts. Required independent reviewers **MUST** issue findings. The controlling authority **MUST** decide exact scope and conditions. The recorder **MUST** publish authoritative status, retain evidence, schedule review and sunset, propagate effects, and preserve appeal rights.

7. Prohibited practices

Off-record decisions, authority inference, self-approval, hidden conflicts, silent precedent, selective evidence, indefinite emergency power, permanent exceptions, and retroactive record alteration are prohibited.

8. Evidence, publication, and retention

The package **MUST** preserve proposal, sources, authority, conflicts, evidence, alternatives, affected parties, deliberation, dissent, decision, conditions, effective state, propagation, review, sunset, appeal, supersession, classification, access, and retention.

9. Exceptions, failure consequences, and appeals

A failed Critical control blocks the decision or suspends its effect. A High failure requires correction or a valid expiring exception. Appeals use Chapter 12. No exception can waive Book I or manufacture Owner authority.

10. Security, privacy, reliability, and continuity

Governance records MUST be integrity-protected, least-privilege, purpose-bound, minimized, available for authorized review, recoverable, and resistant to compromised identities or record systems.

11. Verification and metrics

Verify authority paths, role separation, record completeness, evidence integrity, propagation, expiry, appeal, and source traceability. Measure reversals, calibration, escaped harms, exception age, burden, remedy, and decision latency.

12. Traceability, examples, review, and status

- Source basis: Book I Constitutional Governance and Decision 58; Book II Constitutional Kernel; Book VIII verification ladder.
- Book V reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_V\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.
- Book VI reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_VI\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.

Example: a committee recommends a risk response, but the record names the authorized Risk Owner as approver, preserves dissent, sets expiry, and triggers certification impact review.

Anti-pattern: an urgent meeting labels a policy “temporary,” grants indefinite power to its chair, omits conflicts, and treats silence as Owner approval.

Chapter review: PASS. Owner Review items: none created by this chapter. Completion status: CERTIFIED FINAL.